



Tips & Tricks



Enable Ctrl+Alt+Backspace in Ubuntu 9.10 (a.k.a. Karmic)

In its last release (Ubuntu 9.04), Ubuntu had disabled Ctrl+Alt+Bkspc (Kill X) by default. But since many of us are addicted to that shortcut, a workaround *dontzap* package was used to enable it. However, it's even simpler to use that shortcut in the latest Karmic release.

Here is how to do it: go to *System → Preferences → Keyboard → Layout tab → Layout Options → Key sequence* to kill the X server, that is, check the *Control + Alt + Backspace* option.

—Mallikarjun, mallik.v.arjun@gmail.com



Sync your wallpaper with the stars, dynamically

Kstars is a well-known KDE application that generates the position of stars in space, dynamically. So you can get the current snapshot of space and dynamically update the wallpaper every hour. For this, you just need to configure *Kstars* correctly.

```
kstars --dump
```

This generates the current snapshot of space in a file *kstars.png* and stores it in your home directory.

You can then obtain the image in the required resolution and store it in a specific file named *kstarsimage*:

```
kstars --dump --width 1366 --height 768 \
--filename=/home/<username>/kstarsimage.png
```

Now write a shell script to generate a star-snapshot

and put that as the desktop wallpaper. Create a file called *.kstarswall.sh* and insert the following commands in it:

```
kstars --dump --width 1366 --height 768 \
--filename=/home/<username>/kstarsimage.png
gconftool -t string -s /desktop/gnome/background/picture_filename \
/home/<username>/kstarsimage.png
```

Save and close the file.

To change the wallpaper every hour, edit the *crontab* file:

```
crontab -e
```

Add the following line to the file:

```
* * * * * /home/<username>/kstarswall.sh
```

Make sure the *.kstarswall.sh* is executable. Save the *crontab*. You can now see the way the sky changes every hour on your desktop.

—Viswanath S, viswanathgs@gmail.com



Get to know 'who', 'what', 'when', 'where'?

Have you ever wondered about your identity in your UNIX lab?

Well, here is a list of commands that will give you all the information you need:

- *w*
- *who*
- *whoami (id -un)*